

Practice Quiz: Agents — You're Not an NPC

Part A: Multiple Choice

1. An **agent** is someone or something that: A) Only follows instructions without thinking
B) Has goals, makes predictions, and takes actions C) Never makes mistakes D) Always does what everyone else does

Answer: B — An agent senses, has goals, predicts, and acts. That's you every day.

1. What is the difference between acting like an NPC and acting like an agent? A) NPCs are smarter B) Agents follow their programming; NPCs make choices C) NPCs follow routines without thinking; agents make deliberate choices D) There is no difference

Answer: C — NPCs just follow programming, while agents stop, consider options, and decide.

1. When you decide whether to raise your hand in class, your brain is: A) Just reacting randomly B) Running a mental simulation and choosing based on the results C) Doing nothing important D) Copying what other people do

Answer: B — You're predicting what might happen, weighing options, and choosing — all in about two seconds.

1. Why do you and your friend sometimes disagree about where to sit at lunch? A) One of you is always wrong B) You have different mental models optimizing for different things C) Someone is being mean D) You never actually disagree

Answer: B — Different goals and models lead to different preferences. Neither is broken.

1. Your brain puts most of your day on **autopilot** because: A) It's lazy B) It saves energy for important decisions C) It doesn't care about you D) Thinking is impossible

Answer: B — Autopilot handles routine tasks so your brain has energy for the big stuff.

1. The "social superpower" described in the module is: A) Being able to read minds B) Always being right C) Asking "What's their model? What are they trying to achieve?" when someone confuses you D) Ignoring everyone around you

Answer: C — Understanding other people's models helps you understand their behavior.

1. Which of these is the best example of someone acting on autopilot? A) Choosing a college major after careful research B) Scrolling through your phone without really noticing what you're looking at C) Deciding to try out for a new sport D) Having a serious talk with a friend about a problem

Answer: B — Mindless scrolling is classic autopilot — doing something without deliberate choice.

1. Everyone else being an agent means: A) They all agree with you B) They each have their own goals, models, and predictions C) They are all NPCs D) They don't think about anything

Answer: B — Every person around you is also running their own mental simulations and making their own choices.

1. A good test for knowing when to switch from autopilot to intentional mode is: A) Wait until something goes wrong B) Ask "Am I choosing this, or am I just doing it because it's what I always do?" C) Never think about it D) Let someone else decide for you

Answer: B — This simple question helps you recognize when you're on autopilot for something important.

1. In a group project, understanding that everyone is an agent helps you: A) Do all the work yourself B) Ignore other people's ideas C) Understand why teammates have different approaches and work with their goals D) Give up and let others lead

Answer: C — Recognizing everyone's different models and goals helps the group work together better.

Part B: Short Answer

1. Describe a time this week when you were on autopilot. What were you doing, and what would have been different if you had switched to intentional mode?
2. Think of someone who recently did something that annoyed or confused you. What do you think their mental model was? What were they predicting? What were they trying to achieve?
3. Imagine you're the "coach" of a group project. How would understanding that each teammate is an agent with different goals help you lead the group?
4. What is one important decision coming up where you should definitely be in intentional mode instead of autopilot? What options will you consider?
5. Give an example from gaming or social media where you acted as a true agent — making a deliberate choice based on predictions rather than just going with the flow.